

CUSTOMER SUCCESS RESOURCE LIBRARY

Success Metrics Reference Dashboard

The Core Metric Set for Reporting Account and Portfolio Health

David Maika · Customer Success Strategist | Operations Excellence | AI-Driven Growth

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davidmaika.com · linkedin.com/in/davidmaika

Success Metrics Reference Dashboard

The Customer Success Metrics That Matter Most and How to Turn Data Into Better Business Decisions

Author: David Maika

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Introduction

"You can't improve what you don't measure. But measuring the wrong things can be just as dangerous as measuring nothing at all."

Customer Success has evolved from a relationship-focused function into one of the most strategic growth engines within modern SaaS businesses.

Today's Customer Success leaders are expected to answer questions that go far beyond customer satisfaction.

- Which customers are most likely to renew?
- Which accounts are showing early signs of churn?
- Where are adoption rates declining?
- Which Customer Success Managers require additional support?
- Which customer segments generate the highest Net Revenue Retention?
- Which accounts are ready for expansion?
- How accurately can we forecast renewals?

The answers to these questions come from data.

But data alone is not enough.

Many organizations collect hundreds of metrics without understanding which ones actually influence customer success.

As a result, dashboards become crowded with numbers that look impressive but provide little guidance for decision-making.

Effective Customer Success reporting focuses on metrics that influence action.

Every metric should answer at least one important business question.

If a metric cannot influence a decision, it probably doesn't belong on an executive dashboard.

Throughout this guide, you'll learn how to identify the metrics that matter most, calculate them correctly, interpret trends instead of isolated numbers, and build dashboards that help Customer Success teams make faster and better decisions.

You'll also learn how Customer Success leaders use these metrics to improve onboarding, increase adoption, reduce churn, strengthen executive relationships, forecast renewals, identify expansion opportunities, and demonstrate measurable business value.

The goal is not to collect more data.

The goal is to build a Customer Success organization that makes smarter decisions because it understands what its data is really saying.

Chapter 2

Why Customer Success Metrics Matter

Customer Success is no longer measured by how many meetings a Customer Success Manager conducts or how quickly emails are answered.

Modern Customer Success is measured by business outcomes.

The organizations that consistently grow revenue, increase retention, reduce churn, and create loyal customers are the ones that make decisions using data rather than assumptions.

Metrics give Customer Success teams visibility into what is happening across their customer portfolio.

They answer questions like:

- Are customers adopting the product?
- Are customers achieving measurable business value?
- Which accounts are at risk?
- Which customers are likely to renew?
- Which accounts are ready for expansion?
- Where should Customer Success Managers focus their attention first?

Without metrics, Customer Success becomes reactive.

With metrics, Customer Success becomes proactive.

For example, imagine two customers.

Both attended onboarding.

Both completed implementation.

Both responded positively during kickoff meetings.

On the surface, they appear equally healthy.

However, after reviewing customer metrics, a different story emerges.

Customer A has:

- 94% feature adoption.
- Weekly executive engagement.
- High Customer Health Score.
- Declining support requests.
- Consistent business outcomes.

Customer B has:

- 38% feature adoption.
- No executive engagement for two months.
- Increasing support tickets.
- Declining login frequency.
- Multiple overdue action items.

Without metrics, both customers look healthy.

With metrics, Customer Success immediately knows where intervention is needed.

Metrics transform opinions into evidence.

Rather than saying,

"I think this customer might churn."

A Customer Success Manager can say,

"Product adoption has declined by 35% over the past sixty days, executive engagement has stopped, and customer sentiment has shifted from positive to neutral. Based on these indicators, this account requires immediate intervention."

This level of insight improves forecasting, prioritization, executive reporting, and customer outcomes.

Customer Success metrics are not designed to create more reports.

They exist to help teams make better business decisions.

Chapter 3

Leading vs. Lagging Indicators

One of the biggest reporting mistakes organizations make is focusing only on results that have already happened.

These are known as **lagging indicators**.

Lagging indicators tell you what happened.

Leading indicators help predict what is likely to happen next.

Exceptional Customer Success teams monitor both.

Leading Indicators

Leading indicators provide early warning signals.

They allow Customer Success Managers to intervene before customer problems become customer losses.

Examples include:

Product adoption.

Weekly active users.

Feature utilization.

Executive engagement.

Training completion.

Customer sentiment.

Support ticket trends.

Stakeholder engagement.

Implementation progress.

Milestone completion.

Customer Health Score.

Because these indicators change before renewal decisions are made, they provide opportunities for proactive action.

Lagging Indicators

Lagging indicators measure completed outcomes.

Examples include:

Renewal Rate.

Gross Revenue Retention.

Net Revenue Retention.

Customer Churn Rate.

Expansion Revenue.

Customer Lifetime Value.

Annual Recurring Revenue.

Net Promoter Score.

These metrics are essential for measuring overall business performance.

However, they cannot change the past.

Once churn has occurred, the opportunity to prevent it has already been lost.

Practical Example

Consider FlyTrack Logistics.

Three months before renewal, customer usage began declining.

Executive meetings became less frequent.

Support requests increased.

Customer sentiment shifted from highly positive to neutral.

These were leading indicators.

If ignored, the company would likely face a difficult renewal.

Instead, the Customer Success Manager identified the trend early, launched a recovery plan, re-engaged executive stakeholders, and restored healthy adoption.

When renewal arrived, the customer renewed successfully.

The Renewal Rate became the lagging indicator.

The earlier adoption and engagement trends were the leading indicators that made success possible.

The lesson is simple.

Leading indicators help you influence outcomes.

Lagging indicators confirm the results of those actions.

High-performing Customer Success organizations monitor leading indicators every week and review lagging indicators every month or quarter.

Chapter 4

Building a Metrics-Driven Customer Success Organization

Metrics should never exist simply because a dashboard can display them.

Every metric should support a business decision.

A metrics-driven Customer Success organization creates a culture where decisions are based on evidence rather than assumptions.

This starts with defining success clearly.

Leadership must determine which customer outcomes matter most.

Examples include:

Improving product adoption.

Increasing renewal rates.

Growing Net Revenue Retention.

Reducing customer churn.

Accelerating Time to Value.

Improving executive engagement.

Increasing expansion revenue.

Once these objectives are defined, supporting metrics become much easier to identify.

For example:

If the objective is improving onboarding, monitor:

- Time to First Value.
- Implementation completion rate.
- Training completion.
- Early product adoption.

If the objective is improving renewals, monitor:

- Customer Health Score.
- Executive engagement.
- Product adoption.

- Business outcomes achieved.
- Renewal readiness.

A mature Customer Success organization also creates standardized metric definitions.

Everyone should calculate Customer Health, Adoption Rate, Net Revenue Retention, Churn Rate, and Expansion Rate using the same methodology.

Otherwise, different teams begin reporting different numbers for the same metric.

Consistency creates trust.

Finally, reporting should encourage action.

Every dashboard should answer three questions:

What happened?

Why did it happen?

What should we do next?

When dashboards answer those questions, they become strategic decision-making tools rather than collections of interesting charts.

Chapter 5

The Customer Success Metrics Framework

An effective Customer Success dashboard should organize metrics into logical categories instead of displaying dozens of unrelated numbers.

This framework groups Customer Success metrics into six core business areas.

1. Adoption Metrics

These measure whether customers are actively using the product.

Examples include:

- Daily Active Users (DAU).
- Weekly Active Users (WAU).
- Monthly Active Users (MAU).
- Feature Adoption Rate.
- License Utilization.
- Workflow Completion Rate.

- Time to First Value.

High adoption generally indicates customers are receiving value.

2. Customer Outcome Metrics

These measure whether customers are achieving the business outcomes defined during onboarding.

Examples include:

- Revenue Growth.
- Cost Reduction.
- Productivity Improvements.
- Time Saved.
- Process Automation.
- Customer Satisfaction Improvements.
- Operational Efficiency.

Business outcomes are often the strongest predictors of long-term retention.

3. Customer Health Metrics

These combine multiple indicators into a single view of customer health.

Typical health dimensions include:

- Product Adoption.
- Business Outcomes.
- Customer Relationship.
- Customer Sentiment.
- Growth Potential.

Health Scores allow Customer Success Managers to prioritize their portfolios more effectively.

4. Financial Metrics

These measure the commercial performance of the customer portfolio.

Examples include:

- Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR).
- Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR).
- Gross Revenue Retention (GRR).
- Net Revenue Retention (NRR).

- Expansion Revenue.
- Churned Revenue.

These metrics connect Customer Success activities directly to business growth.

5. Renewal Metrics

These measure customer retention performance.

Examples include:

- Renewal Rate.
- Renewal Forecast Accuracy.
- Renewal Readiness Score.
- Time-to-Renewal.
- Renewal Pipeline Coverage.

Renewal metrics help leadership forecast future revenue with greater confidence.

6. Expansion Metrics

These measure customer growth opportunities.

Examples include:

- Expansion Pipeline Value.
- Upsell Conversion Rate.
- Cross-sell Revenue.
- Expansion Readiness Score.
- Product Adoption Growth.
- Expansion Win Rate.

Healthy expansion metrics indicate that customers continue finding value in the partnership.

Together, these six categories provide leadership with a complete picture of customer success, customer health, and long-term business growth.

Chapter 6

Adoption Metrics

Adoption is one of the earliest and most reliable indicators of customer success.

A customer cannot achieve meaningful business outcomes if they are not actively using the product.

For this reason, adoption metrics should be reviewed continuously throughout the customer lifecycle---not just during onboarding.

Strong adoption generally leads to:

- Faster Time to Value.
- Higher customer satisfaction.
- Increased renewal probability.
- Greater expansion opportunities.
- Lower churn risk.

Poor adoption often signals hidden problems such as ineffective onboarding, insufficient training, lack of executive sponsorship, poor change management, or product misalignment.

Customer Success Managers should monitor adoption trends rather than isolated numbers.

A customer logging in once after implementation does not indicate adoption.

Consistent usage over time does.

Daily Active Users (DAU)

Measures the number of unique users actively using the platform every day.

Formula

Daily Active Users = Number of unique users who logged in during a 24-hour period

Why It Matters

DAU provides immediate visibility into customer engagement.

Declining DAU often becomes one of the earliest warning signs of adoption problems.

Weekly Active Users (WAU)

Measures unique users actively using the product each week.

Weekly trends often provide a more accurate picture than daily fluctuations.

Monthly Active Users (MAU)

Measures customer engagement across an entire month.

MAU is particularly useful for products used less frequently, such as executive reporting platforms or financial planning systems.

Feature Adoption Rate

Measures how many customers actively use specific product features.

Formula

Feature Adoption Rate = Users actively using a feature ÷ Total eligible users × 100

This metric identifies:

Underused capabilities.

Training opportunities.

Potential expansion opportunities.

Product improvement needs.

License Utilization

Measures how many purchased licenses are actually being used.

Example:

Purchased Licenses:

500

Active Users:

425

License Utilization:

85%

Low utilization often suggests opportunities for improved onboarding or organizational adoption rather than immediate expansion.

Time to First Value (TTFV)

One of the most important Customer Success metrics.

Measures how quickly customers experience their first meaningful business outcome.

Examples include:

First successful workflow.

First completed report.

First automated process.

First customer onboarded.

First operational improvement.

The shorter the Time to First Value, the greater the likelihood of long-term customer success.

Practical Scenario

Nova Health Clinics implemented a patient scheduling platform across twenty medical facilities.

Initial onboarding appeared successful.

However, adoption metrics revealed only 48% of administrators were actively using automated scheduling features.

Without reviewing adoption data, the implementation would have appeared complete.

Instead, the Customer Success Manager launched additional administrator training, simplified onboarding documentation, and introduced weekly office hours.

Within sixty days:

Feature Adoption increased to 91%.

Support requests declined by 37%.

Executive satisfaction improved significantly.

The improvement was driven by measuring adoption---not assumptions.

Chapter 7

Customer Outcome Metrics

While adoption measures product usage, customer outcome metrics measure whether the customer is actually achieving business value.

These metrics answer the most important Customer Success question:

"Has the customer's business improved because of our partnership?"

Every Success Plan should define measurable outcomes before implementation begins.

Customer Success should regularly compare actual performance against those agreed objectives.

Examples include:

Revenue growth.

Operational efficiency.

Time savings.

Customer satisfaction improvements.

Cost reductions.

Employee productivity.

Compliance improvements.

Customer retention.

These outcomes vary depending on the customer's industry and objectives.

Revenue Growth

Measures additional revenue generated after implementation.

Example

A retail company increases online sales by 18% after implementing personalized customer engagement workflows.

Cost Reduction

Measures operational expenses eliminated through automation or process improvements.

Example:

FlyTrack Logistics reduced manual shipment tracking, saving over 500 operational hours annually.

Productivity Improvement

Measures increased employee efficiency.

Example:

Customer support agents previously handled twenty tickets daily.

After implementation, productivity increased to thirty-two tickets daily.

Time Saved

Measures reductions in manual effort.

Examples include:

Report generation.

Customer onboarding.

Invoice processing.

Approval workflows.

Operational reporting.

Time savings often produce measurable financial returns.

Operational Efficiency

Measures improvements across business processes.

Examples include:

Reduced process delays.

Improved workflow completion.

Lower error rates.

Faster approvals.

Improved collaboration.

Customer Satisfaction Improvement

Measured through:

CSAT.

NPS.

Customer interviews.

Voice of Customer surveys.

Executive feedback.

Higher customer satisfaction frequently predicts stronger renewal performance.

Practical Scenario

A growing e-commerce company partnered with HubSpot to improve lead management and customer engagement.

The Customer Success team agreed on three measurable business outcomes before implementation:

Increase qualified lead conversion.

Reduce manual marketing effort.

Improve campaign reporting visibility.

After six months:

Lead conversion increased by 24%.

Marketing teams reduced manual campaign reporting by nearly 60%.

Executives gained real-time visibility into campaign performance through automated dashboards.

The implementation was considered successful not because users logged in regularly, but because measurable business outcomes had been achieved.

Customer Success should always measure value---not activity.

Chapter 8

Customer Health Metrics

Customer Health Metrics provide a single, structured view of how likely a customer is to achieve long-term success.

Unlike adoption metrics, which measure product usage, Customer Health combines multiple indicators into one overall assessment of the relationship.

A healthy customer is not simply someone who logs in frequently.

A healthy customer is achieving business outcomes, maintaining strong relationships with stakeholders, receiving value from the product, and showing clear signs of long-term growth.

Customer Health Scores help Customer Success Managers answer critical questions such as:

- Which accounts require immediate attention?
- Which customers are ready for expansion?
- Which renewals are at risk?
- Where should Customer Success Managers invest their time first?

Most organizations calculate Customer Health using several weighted categories.

Although the exact weighting varies, the following five-pillar model is widely used.

Product Adoption

Measures how consistently customers use the platform.

Common indicators include:

- Active Users.
- Feature Adoption.
- License Utilization.
- Workflow Completion.
- Time to First Value.

High adoption generally increases overall health.

Business Outcomes

Measures whether customers are achieving the objectives defined during onboarding.

Examples include:

Revenue growth.

Reduced operational costs.

Faster processing time.

Higher productivity.

Improved compliance.

Operational efficiency.

Customers receiving measurable value are significantly more likely to renew.

Customer Relationship

Measures the overall strength of the partnership.

Examples include:

Executive engagement.

Meeting participation.

Stakeholder coverage.

Response times.

Relationship with customer champions.

Relationship diversity across departments.

Strong relationships reduce organizational risk when key contacts leave.

Customer Sentiment

Measures how customers feel about the partnership.

Sources include:

Customer Satisfaction (CSAT).

Net Promoter Score (NPS).

Survey responses.

Support interactions.

Meeting feedback.

Executive conversations.

Positive sentiment often predicts stronger retention.

Growth Potential

Measures opportunities for future customer growth.

Indicators include:

Business expansion.

Increasing product usage.

Additional departments.

Hiring growth.

Executive initiatives.

New strategic priorities.

Expansion discussions.

Growth potential helps prioritize strategic accounts.

Practical Scenario

A rapidly growing software company had two enterprise customers with nearly identical Annual Recurring Revenue.

At first glance, both appeared equally healthy.

However, their Health Scores told a different story.

Customer A

Product Adoption: 95%

Business Outcomes: Excellent

Executive Engagement: Monthly

Customer Sentiment: Positive

Growth Potential: High

Overall Health Score: 94 (Green)

Customer B

Product Adoption: 62%

Business Outcomes: Limited

Executive Engagement: None for three months

Customer Sentiment: Neutral

Growth Potential: Low

Overall Health Score: 63 (Amber)

Although revenue appeared identical, Customer B required immediate intervention.

Within two weeks, the Customer Success Manager scheduled executive alignment meetings, launched additional training sessions, and updated the Customer Success Plan.

Three months later, Customer Health improved to 86, and the customer successfully renewed. Health Scores help Customer Success teams prioritize effort where it creates the greatest impact.

Chapter 9

Financial Metrics

Customer Success is no longer viewed solely as a support function.

It is now recognized as a significant driver of recurring revenue, customer retention, and sustainable business growth.

Financial metrics demonstrate this contribution by connecting Customer Success activities directly to business performance.

These are the metrics executive leadership reviews most frequently.

Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR)

ARR measures the predictable annual revenue generated from recurring customer subscriptions.

Formula

ARR = Total Annual Subscription Revenue

ARR helps Customer Success understand the overall value of its managed portfolio.

Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)

MRR measures recurring subscription revenue on a monthly basis.

Formula

MRR = Total Monthly Subscription Revenue

MRR helps organizations monitor short-term revenue performance and forecast growth.

Gross Revenue Retention (GRR)

GRR measures the percentage of recurring revenue retained after accounting for churn, excluding expansion revenue.

Formula

GRR = (Starting Revenue -- Churned Revenue) ÷ Starting Revenue × 100

High-performing SaaS organizations typically target Gross Revenue Retention above 90%.

Net Revenue Retention (NRR)

Net Revenue Retention measures recurring revenue after considering churn, contractions, and expansion revenue.

Formula

$$\text{NRR} = (\text{Starting Revenue} - \text{Churn} + \text{Expansion Revenue}) \div \text{Starting Revenue} \times 100$$

NRR above 100% indicates that expansion revenue exceeds revenue lost through churn.

This is one of the most closely monitored Customer Success metrics by investors and executive leadership.

Customer Lifetime Value (CLV)

Customer Lifetime Value estimates the total revenue expected from a customer throughout the relationship.

Increasing retention and expansion significantly improves Customer Lifetime Value.

Revenue Churn

Measures recurring revenue lost due to cancellations or downgrades.

Reducing Revenue Churn is one of the primary objectives of every Customer Success organization.

Practical Scenario

A SaaS company reviewed its quarterly financial performance.

The numbers showed:

Starting ARR:

\\$12 million

Churned Revenue:

\\$600,000

Expansion Revenue:

\\$1.4 million

Using the Net Revenue Retention formula:

$$(\$12\text{M} - \$600\text{K} + \$1.4\text{M}) \div \$12\text{M} \times 100$$

$$\text{NRR} = \mathbf{106.7\%}$$

Although some customers had churned, expansion revenue more than compensated for those losses.

Leadership viewed Customer Success as a major contributor to overall business growth because healthy customers continued expanding their investment.

Financial metrics help Customer Success demonstrate measurable commercial impact rather than simply reporting customer activity.

Chapter 10

Renewal & Retention Metrics

Customer Success exists to help customers achieve lasting business outcomes.

When customers consistently realize value, renewals become the natural outcome rather than the primary objective.

Renewal and retention metrics help Customer Success teams understand not only how many customers are staying but also why they are staying---or leaving.

These metrics should be reviewed continuously, not just when contracts approach expiration.

Renewal Rate

Renewal Rate measures the percentage of customers who renew their contracts at the end of their subscription period.

Formula

Renewal Rate = (Number of Renewed Customers ÷ Number of Customers Eligible to Renew) × 100

Why It Matters

Renewal Rate is one of the clearest indicators of Customer Success performance.

High renewal rates usually indicate:

- Strong customer relationships.
- Successful onboarding.
- High product adoption.
- Measurable business outcomes.
- Effective executive engagement.

A declining Renewal Rate often signals deeper issues within onboarding, adoption, customer health, or stakeholder alignment.

Gross Customer Retention

This metric measures how many customers remain active over a given period without considering expansion revenue.

Formula

Gross Customer Retention = (Customers at End of Period -- New Customers) ÷ Customers at Start of Period × 100

This provides a clear picture of customer loyalty.

Customer Churn Rate

Customer Churn measures the percentage of customers lost during a specific period.

Formula

Customer Churn Rate = (Customers Lost ÷ Customers at Start of Period) × 100

Reducing churn remains one of the most important responsibilities of Customer Success.

Renewal Forecast Accuracy

Customer Success leaders regularly forecast expected renewals.

Forecast Accuracy measures how closely those predictions match actual results.

Formula

Forecast Accuracy = Correct Renewal Predictions ÷ Total Renewal Predictions × 100

Accurate forecasting improves financial planning across the organization.

Renewal Readiness Score

Rather than waiting until the final months of a contract, many organizations assign every customer a Renewal Readiness Score.

Typical scoring factors include:

- Customer Health Score.
- Product Adoption.
- Executive Engagement.
- Business Outcomes Achieved.
- Support History.
- Stakeholder Coverage.
- Open Risks.

- Customer Sentiment.

This score helps prioritize proactive intervention months before renewal discussions begin.

Practical Scenario

A technology company managed more than three hundred enterprise customers.

Historically, Customer Success teams only focused on renewals ninety days before contract expiration.

After implementing Renewal Readiness Scores, every account was reviewed one hundred and twenty days before renewal.

During one review cycle, twenty-three customers were identified as high risk due to declining executive engagement and low feature adoption.

Instead of waiting for renewal conversations, Customer Success Managers immediately launched recovery plans.

Actions included:

Executive alignment meetings.

Additional customer training.

Updated Success Plans.

Quarterly Business Reviews.

Stakeholder expansion.

By renewal season, eighteen of the twenty-three accounts renewed successfully.

Renewal Rate increased from 88% to 95% within one year.

The improvement came from acting on leading indicators rather than reacting to expired contracts.

Chapter 11

Expansion Metrics

Expansion is one of the strongest indicators that customers are receiving continuous value.

Customers rarely increase their investment because of persuasive sales presentations.

They expand because they believe the partnership is helping them achieve increasingly important business outcomes.

Expansion metrics help Customer Success identify where additional value can be created.

Expansion Revenue

Expansion Revenue measures additional recurring revenue generated from existing customers.

Sources include:

- Additional licenses.
- New business units.
- Product upgrades.
- Premium features.
- Cross-sell opportunities.
- Geographic expansion.

Formula

Expansion Revenue = Total Additional Revenue Generated From Existing Customers

Expansion Rate

Measures how successfully Customer Success converts healthy accounts into expanded partnerships.

Formula

Expansion Rate = Customers Expanded ÷ Eligible Customers × 100

Expansion Pipeline Value

Represents the total estimated value of qualified expansion opportunities currently being managed.

This metric helps leadership forecast future revenue growth.

Upsell Conversion Rate

Measures how many qualified upsell opportunities become completed expansions.

Formula

Upsell Conversion Rate = Successful Upsells ÷ Qualified Opportunities × 100

Cross-Sell Success Rate

Measures successful adoption of additional products or solutions within existing customer accounts.

Cross-selling often increases customer stickiness by solving multiple business challenges.

Expansion Readiness Score

Many organizations score expansion readiness using factors such as:

Customer Health Score.

Business Outcomes Achieved.

Executive Relationships.

Product Adoption.

Growth Initiatives.

Organizational Expansion.

Customer Satisfaction.

Strategic Alignment.

Healthy customers with strong scores become priority expansion candidates.

Practical Scenario

A manufacturing company initially deployed workflow automation within a single production facility.

Over the following year, measurable improvements included:

Production efficiency increased by 26%.

Manual reporting time decreased by 58%.

Quality assurance errors reduced significantly.

Employee productivity improved across operations.

During an Executive Business Review, leadership revealed plans to modernize three additional facilities.

Rather than introducing more software immediately, the Customer Success Manager collaborated with the Sales team to build an ROI-focused Expansion Business Case.

Using operational performance data from the first facility, the business case projected similar efficiency gains across the remaining sites.

Leadership approved the expansion because the recommendation was supported by measurable business outcomes---not product demonstrations.

Expansion Revenue increased substantially, while the customer accelerated its digital transformation roadmap.

Expansion succeeds when Customer Success demonstrates proven business value first.

Chapter 12

Executive Dashboard Design

An executive dashboard should not overwhelm leaders with dozens of disconnected metrics.

Its purpose is to provide a clear picture of customer portfolio performance, highlight emerging risks, and support faster, data-driven decisions.

A well-designed dashboard answers four questions immediately:

- How healthy is our customer portfolio?
- Where are the biggest risks?
- Where are the biggest growth opportunities?
- What actions should leadership take next?

If a dashboard cannot answer these questions within a few minutes, it is too complicated.

The best executive dashboards prioritize clarity over complexity.

Section 1 --- Portfolio Overview

This section provides leadership with a high-level snapshot of the Customer Success organization.

Typical metrics include:

- Total Customers
- Total ARR Managed
- Net Revenue Retention (NRR)
- Gross Revenue Retention (GRR)
- Renewal Rate
- Expansion Revenue
- Churn Rate
- Customer Health Distribution

Example

Metric	Current	Target
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Total Customers	412	---
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ARR Managed \ \$28.6M ---

Renewal Rate 95% 94%

NRR 112% 110%

GRR 94% 92%

Expansion Revenue \ \$3.2M \ \$3M

Churn Rate 4.8% \ <6%

This allows executives to understand overall business performance without reviewing individual accounts.

Section 2 --- Customer Health Distribution

Rather than reviewing hundreds of customer records individually, executives should see the overall health distribution.

Example

Health Status Accounts Percentage

Green 268 65%

Amber 104 25%

Red 40 10%

This immediately highlights how much of the customer portfolio requires attention.

Trend analysis is even more valuable than a single monthly snapshot.

Section 3 --- Adoption Dashboard

Key adoption metrics include:

- Daily Active Users
- Weekly Active Users
- Monthly Active Users
- Feature Adoption Rate
- License Utilization
- Time to First Value
- Training Completion Rate

These metrics help identify customers that appear healthy financially but may actually be disengaging from the product.

Section 4 --- Renewal Dashboard

Leadership should have visibility into upcoming renewals.

Recommended metrics include:

- Renewals Due in 120 Days
- Renewals Due in 90 Days
- Renewals Due in 60 Days
- Renewals Due in 30 Days
- Renewal Readiness Score
- Executive Engagement Status
- Renewal Forecast Confidence

This enables proactive planning rather than last-minute intervention.

Section 5 --- Expansion Dashboard

This section highlights future revenue opportunities.

Recommended metrics:

- Qualified Expansion Accounts
- Expansion Pipeline Value
- Expansion Revenue
- Expansion Readiness Score
- Upsell Conversion Rate
- Cross-sell Opportunities

Expansion should always be measured alongside customer health to ensure growth is sustainable.

Section 6 --- Executive Action Dashboard

Every dashboard should conclude with recommended actions.

Examples:

- Accounts requiring executive escalation.
- High-risk renewals.
- Customers with declining adoption.

- Accounts ready for expansion.
- Stakeholder gaps requiring attention.
- Customer Success Plans requiring review.

A dashboard should not simply describe performance.

It should guide action.

Chapter 13

Real World Case Studies

Case Study 1 --- FlyTrack Logistics

FlyTrack Logistics experienced rapid growth after expanding into several new distribution hubs.

As the customer base grew, Customer Success leadership noticed that renewal forecasting became increasingly inaccurate.

Each Customer Success Manager tracked customer health differently.

Some focused heavily on product usage.

Others prioritized executive relationships.

Several relied almost entirely on intuition.

Leadership struggled to obtain a consistent view of portfolio health.

To solve this problem, the company introduced a standardized Customer Success Dashboard.

Every account was evaluated using the same metrics:

- Customer Health Score.
- Product Adoption.
- Executive Engagement.
- Business Outcomes.
- Renewal Readiness.
- Expansion Readiness.

Within one quarter:

Forecast accuracy improved significantly.

Leadership meetings became shorter because everyone referenced the same metrics.

Customer Success Managers prioritized high-risk accounts earlier.

Renewal confidence increased across the entire portfolio.

Case Study 2 --- Nova Health Clinics

Nova Health Clinics managed dozens of healthcare facilities across multiple locations.

Although implementation projects consistently finished on schedule, leadership noticed inconsistent adoption across hospitals.

Rather than measuring implementation completion alone, Customer Success introduced an Adoption Dashboard.

The dashboard tracked:

Administrator Adoption.

Physician Adoption.

Workflow Completion.

Training Progress.

Time to First Value.

Within two months, one hospital showed declining administrator adoption despite successful implementation.

The Customer Success Manager investigated and discovered that several department managers had not completed training.

Additional enablement sessions were scheduled.

Adoption increased rapidly, and the hospital achieved its operational objectives without delaying patient services.

The dashboard prevented a small issue from becoming a much larger customer risk.

Case Study 3 --- HubSpot × Zikoko

Zikoko's marketing team wanted greater visibility into campaign performance across multiple channels.

Instead of creating dozens of individual reports, the Customer Success team designed a single executive dashboard focused on business outcomes.

The dashboard included:

Marketing Qualified Leads.

Campaign Conversion Rate.

Customer Acquisition Cost.

Lead Response Time.

Pipeline Growth.

Executive Goals.

Every Executive Business Review began with this dashboard.

Because discussions focused on business performance instead of individual marketing activities, leadership made faster decisions and prioritized initiatives with the highest measurable impact.

The dashboard became the foundation for every strategic customer conversation.

It transformed reporting from operational updates into executive decision-making.

Chapter 14

Common Reporting Mistakes

Even organizations with sophisticated reporting tools often make fundamental mistakes that reduce the value of their dashboards.

One common mistake is tracking too many metrics.

When executives are presented with fifty different numbers, they often struggle to identify which ones actually require action.

A smaller set of meaningful metrics is far more valuable than an overwhelming collection of statistics.

Another mistake is reporting activity instead of outcomes.

For example:

Number of meetings held.

Emails sent.

Support tickets closed.

While these metrics may indicate effort, they rarely demonstrate customer value.

Customer Success should instead report:

Business outcomes achieved.

Product adoption.

Customer Health.

Renewal readiness.

Expansion opportunities.

Another common mistake is reviewing metrics only after problems occur.

Metrics should function as an early warning system rather than a historical report.

Waiting until renewal season to review adoption or executive engagement significantly reduces the ability to influence outcomes.

Many organizations also fail to standardize metric definitions.

If different teams calculate Customer Health Scores or Renewal Rates differently, executive reports quickly lose credibility.

Finally, dashboards should never exist without accountability.

Every key metric should have an owner responsible for monitoring performance, investigating changes, and recommending corrective action.

Metrics without ownership rarely drive meaningful improvement.

Chapter 15

AI Workflow for Customer Success Reporting

One of the biggest challenges in Customer Success reporting is not the lack of data---it's the overwhelming amount of it.

Customer Success Managers collect information from multiple systems every day:

- CRM records.
- Customer Health Scores.
- Product analytics.
- Support tickets.
- Executive Business Reviews.
- Customer Success Plans.
- Stakeholder Maps.
- Meeting notes.
- Product feedback.
- Customer surveys.
- Renewal forecasts.

Individually, each source provides useful information.

Combined, they create a complete picture of customer health.

Artificial Intelligence helps Customer Success teams consolidate this information, identify patterns, and generate meaningful insights in minutes rather than hours.

Step 1 --- Collect the Data

Before asking AI to generate reports, gather information from all relevant sources.

Typical inputs include:

Customer profile.

Industry.

Contract value.

Customer Health Score.

Product usage metrics.

Support history.

Meeting summaries.

Business outcomes achieved.

Stakeholder engagement.

Renewal timeline.

Expansion opportunities.

The quality of AI-generated reporting depends heavily on the quality of the data provided.

Step 2 --- Analyze Customer Health

AI can review multiple indicators simultaneously.

Example Prompt:

Act as a Customer Success Operations Manager. Review the customer information below and analyze Customer Health across Product Adoption, Business Outcomes, Customer Relationships, Customer Sentiment, and Growth Potential. Identify positive trends, emerging risks, and recommended actions.

Within seconds, AI can produce:

- Overall Health Summary.
- Key Risk Factors.
- Positive Trends.
- Missing Stakeholders.
- Executive Recommendations.
- Priority Actions.

Step 3 --- Generate Executive Summaries

Executives rarely want to review detailed operational reports.

They want concise business insights.

AI can transform detailed account information into executive-ready summaries highlighting:

Business objectives.

Progress against goals.

Measurable outcomes.

Strategic risks.

Future opportunities.

Recommended decisions.

Step 4 --- Forecast Renewals

Using Customer Health, Adoption Trends, Stakeholder Engagement, and Business Outcomes, AI can identify accounts that require immediate attention.

Rather than manually reviewing hundreds of accounts, Customer Success leaders receive prioritized renewal recommendations.

Step 5 --- Identify Expansion Opportunities

Healthy customers often generate expansion opportunities before Sales notices them.

AI can identify:

Growing user populations.

Increasing feature adoption.

Executive strategic initiatives.

New departments.

Business expansion.

Underutilized product capabilities.

These insights help Customer Success initiate strategic business conversations rather than reactive sales discussions.

Step 6 --- Build Leadership Dashboards

AI can summarize portfolio performance into leadership-ready reports.

Typical dashboard sections include:

Portfolio Health.

Renewal Forecast.

Expansion Pipeline.

Adoption Trends.

Customer Outcomes.

High-Risk Accounts.

Executive Priorities.

Recommended Actions.

Instead of spending hours building reports manually, Customer Success leaders can focus on interpreting insights and making decisions.

Chapter 16

Best Practices

The value of Customer Success reporting is determined not by the number of dashboards produced, but by the quality of decisions those dashboards support.

The following best practices help ensure that reporting drives action rather than simply documenting performance.

Focus on Business Outcomes

Always prioritize metrics that demonstrate customer value.

Executives care far more about:

Business outcomes.

Retention.

Revenue growth.

Operational improvements.

Customer health.

Than they do about:

Meeting counts.

Email volume.

Support activity.

Report the metrics that matter.

Standardize Metric Definitions

Every Customer Success Manager should calculate metrics the same way.

This includes:

Customer Health Score.

Renewal Rate.

Expansion Rate.

Feature Adoption.

Time to First Value.

Forecast Confidence.

Consistency improves reporting accuracy and executive trust.

Review Trends, Not Snapshots

One month's data rarely tells the whole story.

Instead, monitor trends across time.

Questions to ask include:

- Is adoption increasing or decreasing?
- Is customer health improving?
- Are executive relationships becoming stronger?
- Are renewal risks increasing?

Trends reveal patterns that isolated numbers cannot.

Combine Quantitative and Qualitative Insights

Numbers explain what is happening.

Conversations explain why.

Combine dashboard metrics with:

Executive feedback.

Meeting notes.

Customer interviews.

Support conversations.

Customer surveys.

The strongest reports combine data with context.

Keep Dashboards Action-Oriented

Every report should answer three questions:

What happened?

Why did it happen?

What should we do next?

If a dashboard cannot guide action, it needs improvement.

Automate Repetitive Reporting

Use AI to automate:

Executive summaries.

Health Score reviews.

Trend analysis.

Meeting summaries.

Quarterly reports.

Renewal forecasting.

Expansion analysis.

This allows Customer Success Managers to spend more time helping customers achieve success.

Chapter 17

Complete Success Metrics Dashboard Template

Executive Summary

Reporting Period:

Prepared By:

Review Date:

Portfolio Overview

Metric	Current	Target	Status
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Total Customers

ARR Managed

Renewal Rate

Net Revenue Retention

Gross Revenue Retention

Expansion Revenue

Churn Rate

Customer Health Distribution

Health Status Accounts Percentage

Green

Amber

Red

Adoption Metrics

Metric Current Target

DAU

WAU

MAU

Feature Adoption

License Utilization

Time to First Value

Renewal Dashboard

Metric Current

Renewals in 120 Days

Renewals in 90 Days

Renewals in 60 Days

Renewals in 30 Days

Forecast Confidence

Renewal Readiness

Expansion Dashboard

Metric Current

Qualified Opportunities

Expansion Pipeline

Expansion Revenue

Upsell Conversion Rate

Expansion Readiness

High-Risk Accounts

Customer Health Score Primary Risk Owner Action

Executive Priorities

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Recommended Actions

Chapter 18

Conclusion

Customer Success metrics are far more than numbers displayed on dashboards.

They are the foundation for strategic decision-making.

When organizations measure the right indicators, review trends consistently, and connect every metric to meaningful business outcomes, Customer Success evolves from a reactive support function into a proactive driver of growth.

The most successful Customer Success teams don't report data simply because it's available.

They report information that helps leaders make better decisions, helps Customer Success Managers prioritize effectively, and helps customers achieve measurable results.

Combined with thoughtful analysis, standardized reporting, and responsible use of Artificial Intelligence, a well-designed Success Metrics Dashboard becomes one of the most valuable tools in any Customer Success organization.

The goal isn't to build more dashboards.

The goal is to build dashboards that inspire action, strengthen customer relationships, improve retention, uncover growth opportunities, and clearly demonstrate the business impact of Customer Success.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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